B18 Documentation and communication

Docstrings, READMEs, model cards and decision logs.

B18-L1 Docstrings and READMEs that answer the next person's questions

Docstrings state grain, units, missing values and what None means. The README states purpose, quick start, inputs, config, tests and owners.

```python
def weighted_share(df: pd.DataFrame, value: str, weight: str) -> float | None:
    """Weighted mean of a 0/1 column. Grain: one row per respondent.

    Args:
        df: Respondent-level data.
        value: 0/1 column to average.
        weight: Non-negative weight column. Rows with a missing value or weight are dropped.

    Returns:
        The weighted share, or None when no rows remain or weights sum to 0.

    Raises:
        KeyError: If a named column is missing.
    """
```

Google-style docstring sections	One-line summary, then Args:, Returns:, Raises:.
What a data docstring must state	Grain, units, missing and zero handling, and what None means.
README sections	Purpose, quick start, inputs and outputs, configuration, tests, owners.
Keeping docs true	Update docstrings in the same commit as the code. Test the quick start where possible.

B18-L2 Model cards that state limits as clearly as scores

A model card states purpose, limits, data, honest metrics, subgroup results and monitoring, and is reviewed with every model change.

Model card sections	Details, intended use, out-of-scope uses, training data, evaluation, subgroups, limitations, monitoring.
How to report a metric on a card	With test period, prevalence and row count.
Why out-of-scope uses	They stop reuse for decisions the model was never validated for.
Keep cards honest	Template with required sections, reviewed in the model's pull request, checked in CI.

B18-L3 Decision logs, so the reasons outlive the meeting

One short, dated entry per decision, with options, consequences and status, linked from the code it explains, and superseded rather than edited.

```
## D-007: Trim survey weights at 5
Date: 2026-09-12. Status: accepted.
Context: Four respondents had weights above 12 and moved brand share by 4 points.
Options considered:
- No trimming
```

```
- Trim at 5, redistribute to keep the weighted total
- Rake with bounded weights
Decision: Trim at 5 with redistribution. Raking deferred until the new panel design.
Consequences: Design effect falls from 2.1 to 1.6. Small bias towards the sample
  profile. Review at wave 20.
```

Parts of a decision entry	ID and title, date and status, context, options considered, decision, consequences.
When a decision changes	Add a new entry. Mark the old one superseded and link to the new one.
Where and when to write	In the repository, in the same pull request as the change.
Make it findable	Link from the config value, the model card and the assumptions log.